

Off-Again Tony; On-Again Stan

By LESTER KOELLING

A contributing factor in a successful season is having the good fortune to pick the right pitcher at the right time.

Sometimes it comes by a thorough knowledge of your pitchers and what can be expected of them against certain clubs on any given day—like Stan Williams of St. Paul against Indianapolis. But sometimes it develops into a guessing game, particularly if you have a Tony Ponce on your staff.

Ponce, largely because of his almost exclusive reliance on the knuckleball pitch, is an unpredictable hurler on the staff of the Indianapolis Indians. He either has it good, or he does not have anything. There's nothing in between about this veteran.

The problem, then, is to determine just what day or night he's going to be "right." But no one, not even Ponce, can supply that answer. You just find out by sending him to the mound and, like Ponce says himself: "If they get two or three straight hits off me, take me out, I ain't got it."

That's what Manager Andy Cohen did last night on Ponce's second straight false start since losing two 1-0 games. Ponce retired the first St. Paul batter, but the next, Bill Lajoie, homered and the next two doubled and singled, although both hits were of the bloop variety. So Manager Cohen pulled Ponce and got good relief work from Roy Tinney.

That start, and two subsequent runs in the first and three in the sixth carried the Saints to a 7-3 victory over the Indians, who went down fighting with two runs in the ninth. Now the Saints are even with the Indians here in 10 games this season and Cloyd Boyer will attempt to dissolve the tie in the series finale tonight.

Maybe Manager Cohen should have started Tinney, whose relief outing showed four runs and eight hits in 8½ innings. On the other

hand, supposing Ponce would have had one of his good nights? He leads the staff with nine complete games and two shutouts.

No such problem confronted Manager Max Macon of the Saints. As long as he had Williams ready, he was practically assured of the outcome. Williams now has started and completed four games against the Indians, and won 'em all. But he always has had the advantage of a fast and big start by his mates, who have not scored fewer than six runs for him against the Tribe.

This was the 13th victory for Williams, who didn't have it quite as easy as the fat 7-1 lead for eight innings would indicate. At several junctures along the way, an Indianapolis hit would have had him in real trouble. The fourth was an example of what could have been disastrous consequences.

BASES FULL; ONE RUN

Williams, not a bit bashful about brushing back batters even when he has a big lead, hit Vince Garcia in the arm. Ron Jackson and Neil Crisley followed with singles and the Indians had the bases full and none out. But all that came of that threat was one run on Jim Delsing's sacrifice fly.

The Indians challenged again in the fifth, sixth and seventh, but failed to carry out the threats until another thrust in the ninth. This could have been a dinger had Garcia's drive to the scoreboard fallen fair instead of into the glove of John Glenn.

The session started on a triple by Sam Mele, who scored on Sam Hairston's hit. A subsequent walk to Jose

TRIBE BOX SCORE

ST. PAUL (7)

	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Curry, 2b.....	5	0	0	1	3	1	
Lajoie, rf.....	3	0	1	3	0	0	
Spears, cf.....	2	0	0	0	0	0	
Larker, 1b.....	4	0	1	9	0	0	
Gray, 3b.....	4	0	2	2	1	2	
Davidson, lf.....	2	1	2	1	2	0	
Glenn, if.....	1	0	0	0	3	0	
Demeter, cf.....	4	0	0	1	1	0	
Lillis, ss.....	4	0	1	3	2	2	
Howell, c.....	4	0	0	1	5	0	
S. Williams, p.....	4	0	0	0	0	0	

37 1 7 11 27 7 1

aPopped out for Lajoie in 7th.

bHit into force-out for Davidson in 7th.

INDIANAPOLIS (3)

	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E
Bernard, 3b.....	2	0	0	0	0	1	
aC. Williams, 3b.....	2	0	0	1	0	0	
Garcia, 2b.....	3	0	1	0	4	3	
Jackson, 1b.....	3	0	0	1	6	1	
Crisley, lf.....	3	0	0	1	1	1	
Delsing, cf.....	2	0	0	0	3	0	
Mele, rf.....	2	0	0	1	1	3	
Hairston, c.....	4	0	1	7	1	0	
Valdivielso, ss.....	2	0	0	2	5	0	
Ponce, p.....	3	0	0	0	0	0	
Tinney, p.....	1	0	0	2	1	0	

32 3 3 7 27 12 1

*At start of game.

aPopped out for Bernard in 7th.

St. Paul..... 400 003 000-7

Indianapolis..... 000 100 002-3

Runs batted in—Lajoie, Gray, Lillis 3, Delsing, Howell 2, Hairston, Garcia, Two-base hits—Larker, Lillis 2, Howell, Tinney, Demeter. Three-base hit—Mele. Home run—Lajoie. Sacrifice flies—Delsing, Garcia. Double plays—Garcia to Valdivielso to Jackson, Lillis to Curry to Larker. Left on base—St. Paul 5, Indianapolis 9.

PITCHING SUMMARY

	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	WP
S. Williams.....	9	7	3	3	3	4	0
Ponce.....	1½	3	3	3	0	0	0
Tinney.....	8½	8	4	3	1	5	0

Hit by pitcher—By Williams (Garcia, Valdivielso) Tinney (Larker). Winning pitcher—Williams (13-6). Losing pitcher—Ponce (8-11). Umpires—Pope, Muller and Carabba. Time—2:12. Attendance—2,048 (paid), 876 (women), 1,558 (kids).

Valdivielso and a hit by Charley Williams loaded the bases for Garcia, whose long drive ended up as a sacrifice fly. The rally ended when Jackson hit into a forceout.

The Saints had everything going for them in this game with several of their hits being of the bloop, bad-hop and chalk-line variety. But they left only five runners stranded and the Indians nine, the exact difference as the score.

In a brief pregame ceremony, Ed Doherty, president of the American Association, presented a silver baseball to Jackson as his reward for being named the outstanding player in the recent All-Star game. Jackson led the Stars to a 5-4 victory over Wichita with a home run and two singled to drive in four tallies.

AMATEUR BASEBALL

The Indianapolis Black Caps would like to schedule a game Sunday. Write or call Ray Highbaugh, 3526 N. Capital, WA 4-2021.



Koelling